# Global E-Commerce Trends 2026

ECDB

# Global E-Commerce Trends 2026: Six Trends Transforming Online Shopping

**#1** **Market Concentration**:
Global growth and revenue is increasingly concentrated in a small set of markets and players

**#2** **Cross-Border E-Commerce**:
Cross-border e-commerce becomes a larger contributor to global GMV growth

**#3** **Top Retailer Growth**:
Retailer concentration rises globally, while the number of mid-sized e-commerce retailers declines

**#4** **Marketplace Dominance**:
Platform-driven ecosystems outgrow “standalone” retail

**#5** **Buyer Acceleration**:
Growth across markets is driven by growth of buyers and buying frequency (ECDB Revenue Equation)

**#6** **Agentic Commerce**:
AI shopping traffic already relevant for retailers; agentic commerce still in the exploration phase



**Sources:** ECDB

### New Phase of Stable Growth

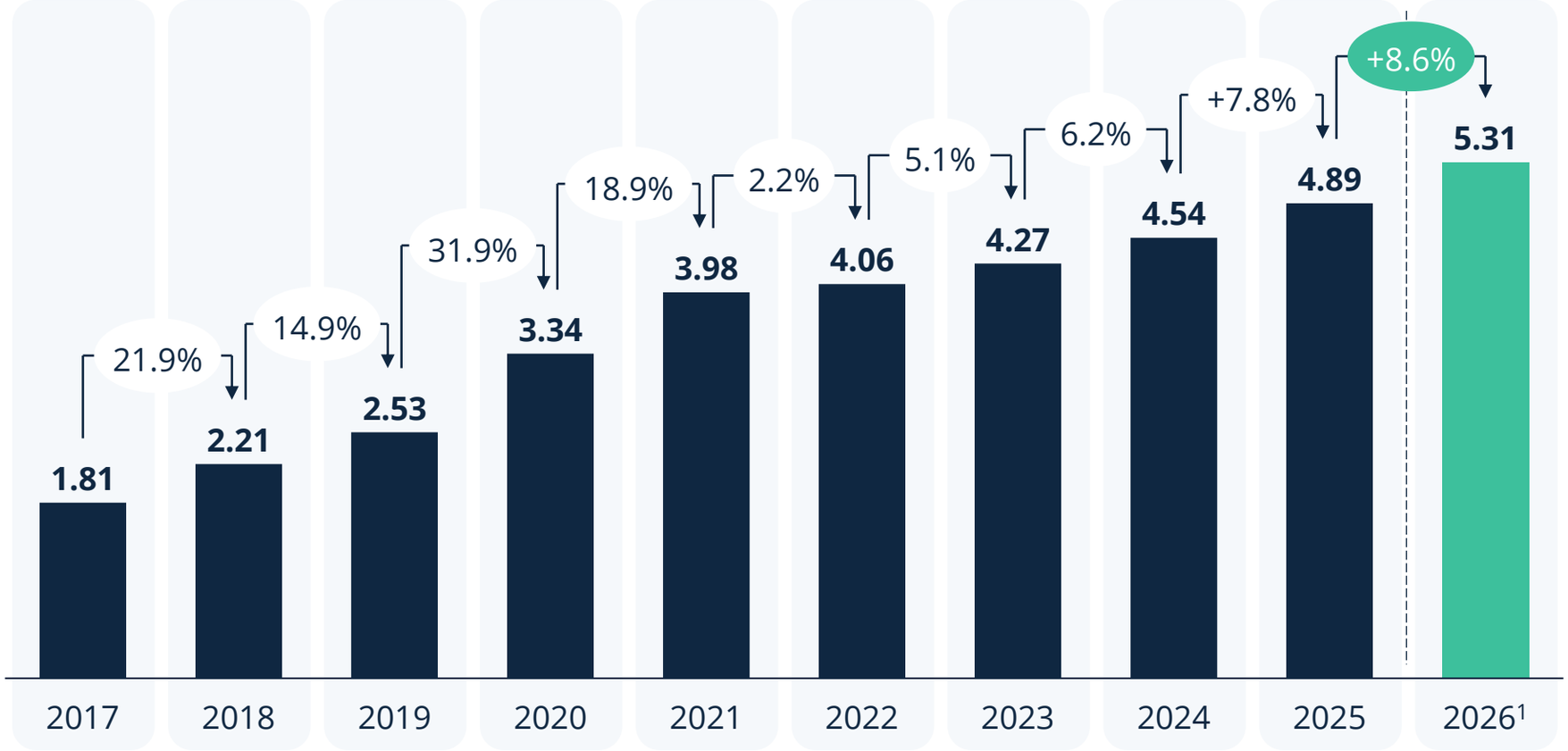
After several volatile years marked by strong pre-pandemic expansion, an exceptional pandemic-driven surge, and a subsequent short-term slowdown, global e-commerce growth is now entering a **phase of normalization**.

Growth rates are stabilizing at a structurally higher steady-state level, reaching 7.8% in 2025 and **accelerating further to 8.6% in 2026**.

A major milestone is reached in 2026, as global e-commerce revenues **exceed US$ 5 trillion for the first time**, underscoring the market's long-term resilience, scale, and sustained relevance in the global retail landscape.

# Revenues Exceed US$ 5 Trillion for the First Time at a Growth Rate of 8.6% Since 2025

**Global e-commerce revenue development (US$ tn)**





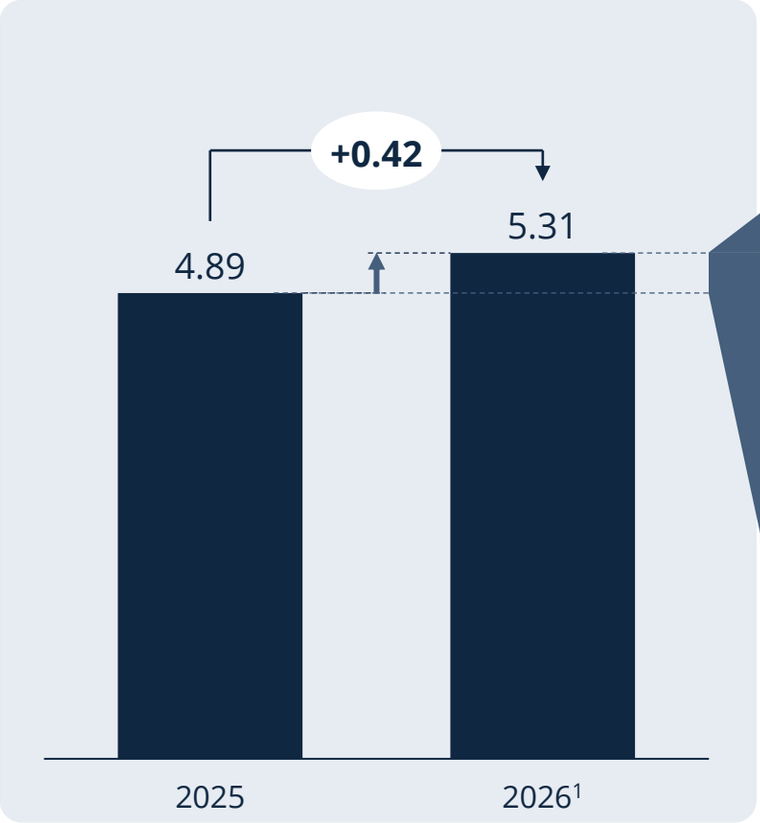

**Notes:** All figures represent nominal year-over-year growth rates, not inflation-adjusted (real) values (1) Forecast

**Sources:** ECDB

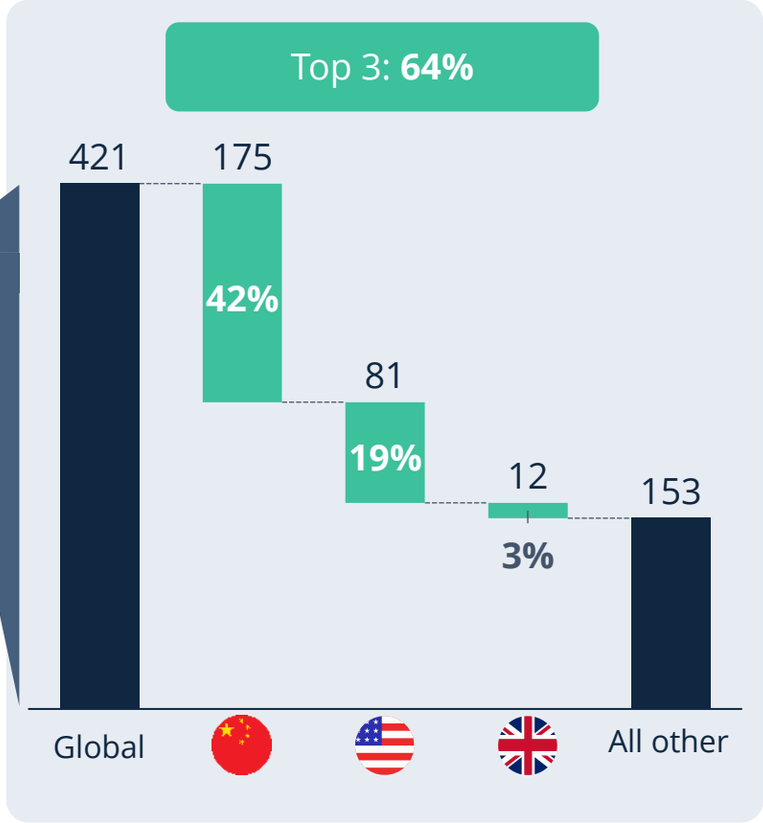
ECDB

# Global Growth Is Increasingly Concentrated in a Small Set of Markets and Players

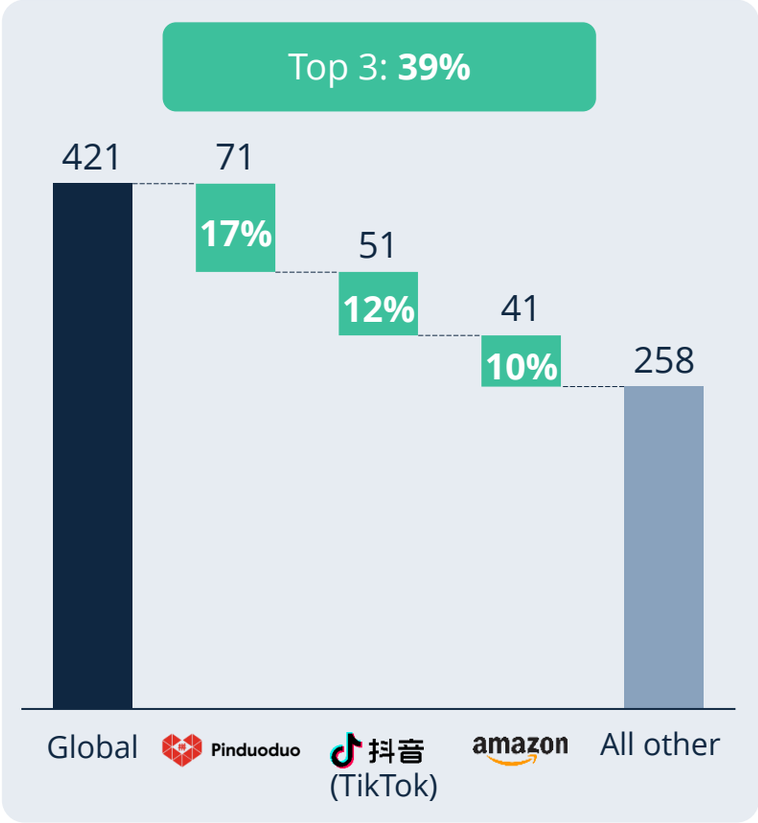
**Global e-commerce revenue (US$ tn)**




**Net growth 25/26 from top 3 countries (US$ bn)**




**Net growth 25/26 from top 3 retailers (US$ bn)[2]**





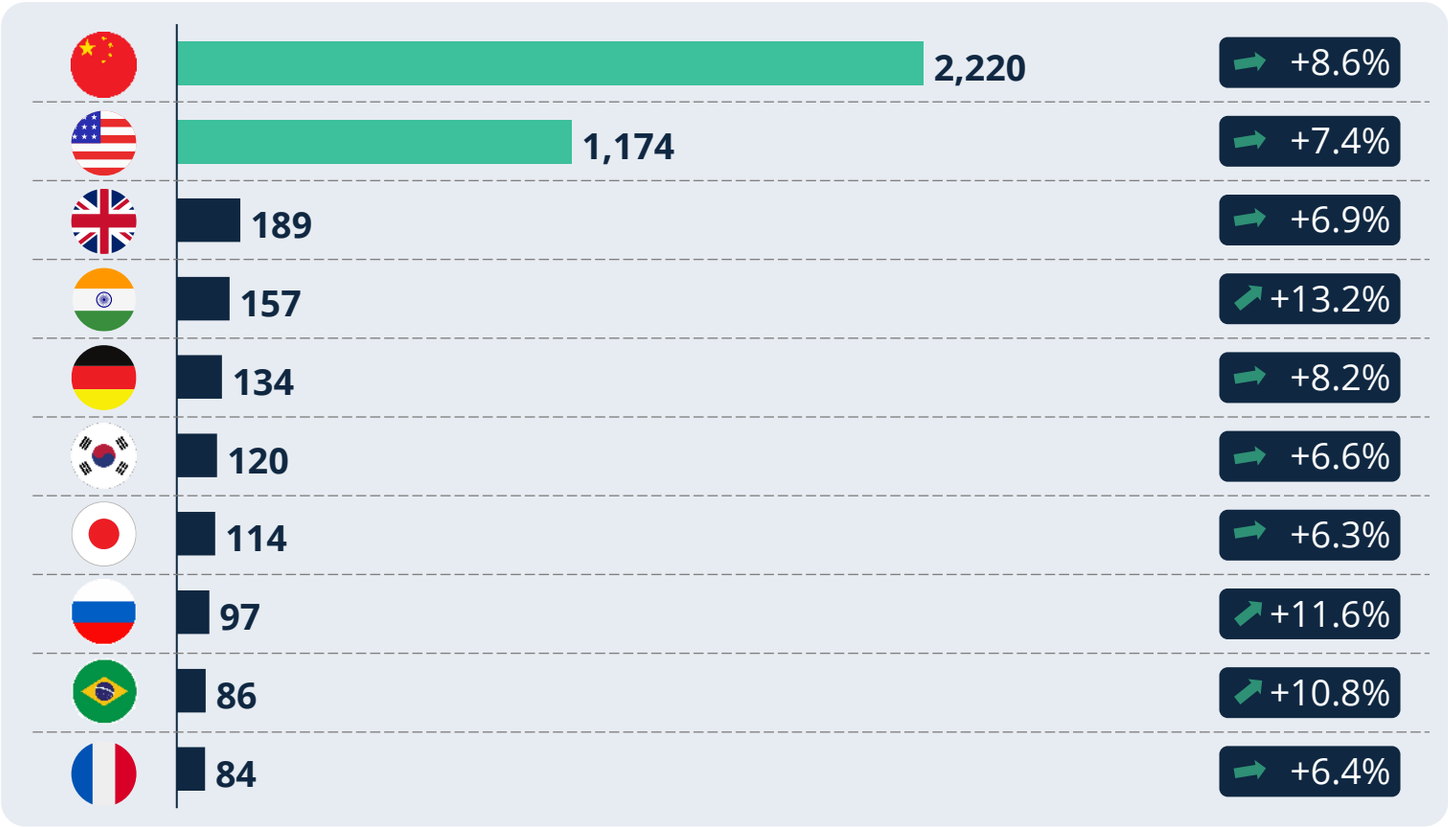

**Notes:** All figures represent nominal year-over-year growth rates, not inflation-adjusted (real) values (1) Forecast (2) Forecast based on GMV and growth 2024-2025 adjusted by growth CAGR 2022-2025. Top 3 retailer GMV figures are adjusted downward by 20% to align with modeled e-commerce market revenues, reflecting the definitional difference between gross merchandise value and net online sales (see page 6)

**Sources:** ECDB

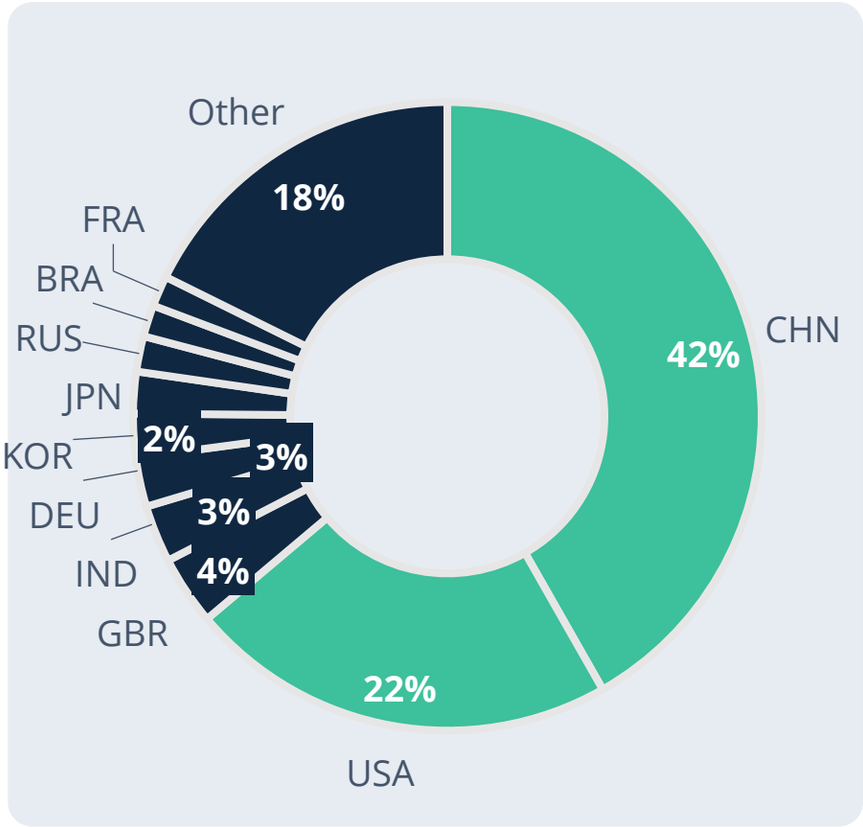
ECDB

# China Dominates Global E-Commerce with a 42% Revenue Share, Followed by the US with a 22% Share in 2026

**Top 10 countries by e-commerce revenue (2026, US$ bn) and growth (2025/2026)**




**Top 10 countries' share of global revenue (2026)**



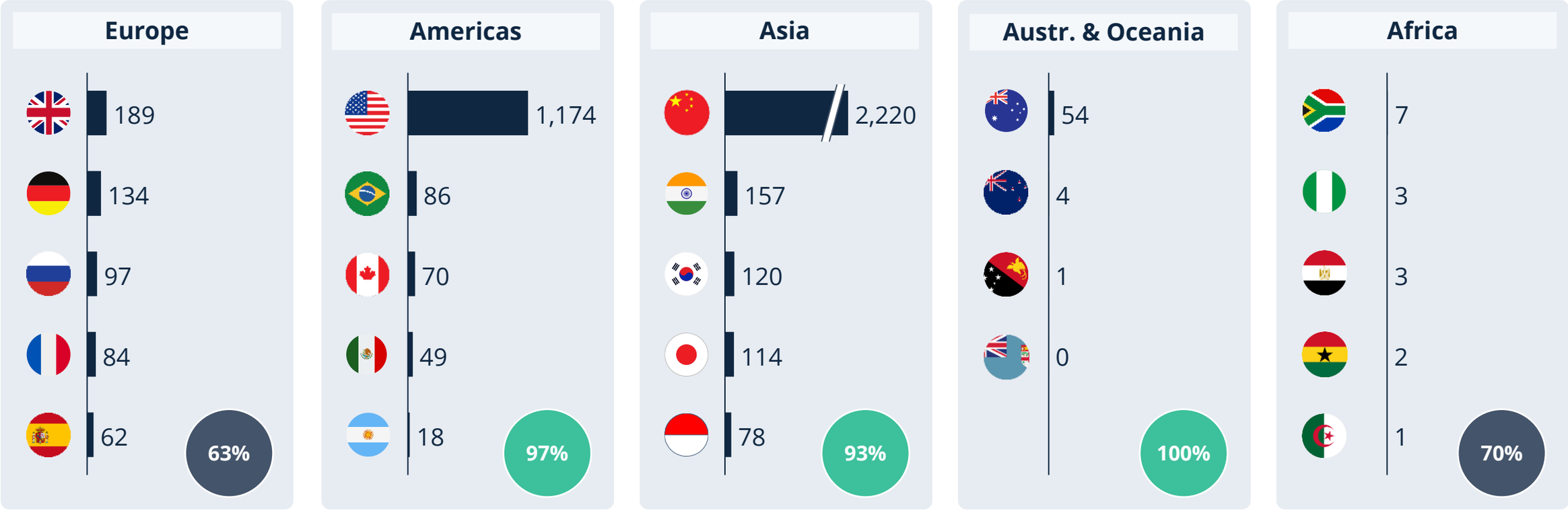



**Sources:** ECDB

ECDB

# E-Commerce Revenue in the Americas, Asia, and Australia & Oceania Is Concentrated in the Top 5 Markets

**E-Commerce revenue of the top 5 countries per region in (2026, US$ bn)**




Share top 5 countries

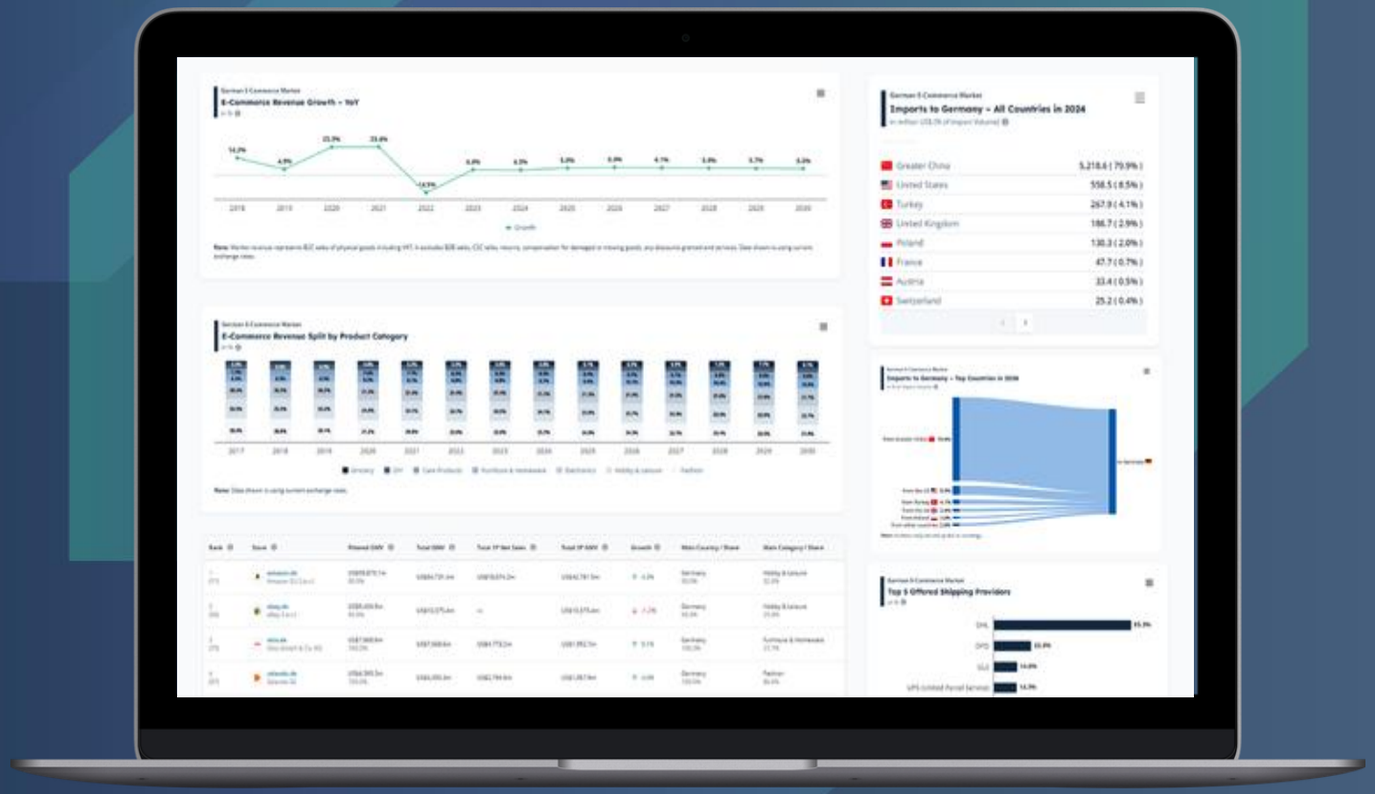


Sources: ECDB

ECDB

# Monitor Where Markets Really Move

- Track demand & growth across the entire market
- Spot category shifts early & identify growth drivers
- Use market-wide benchmarks across retailers, market, and categories



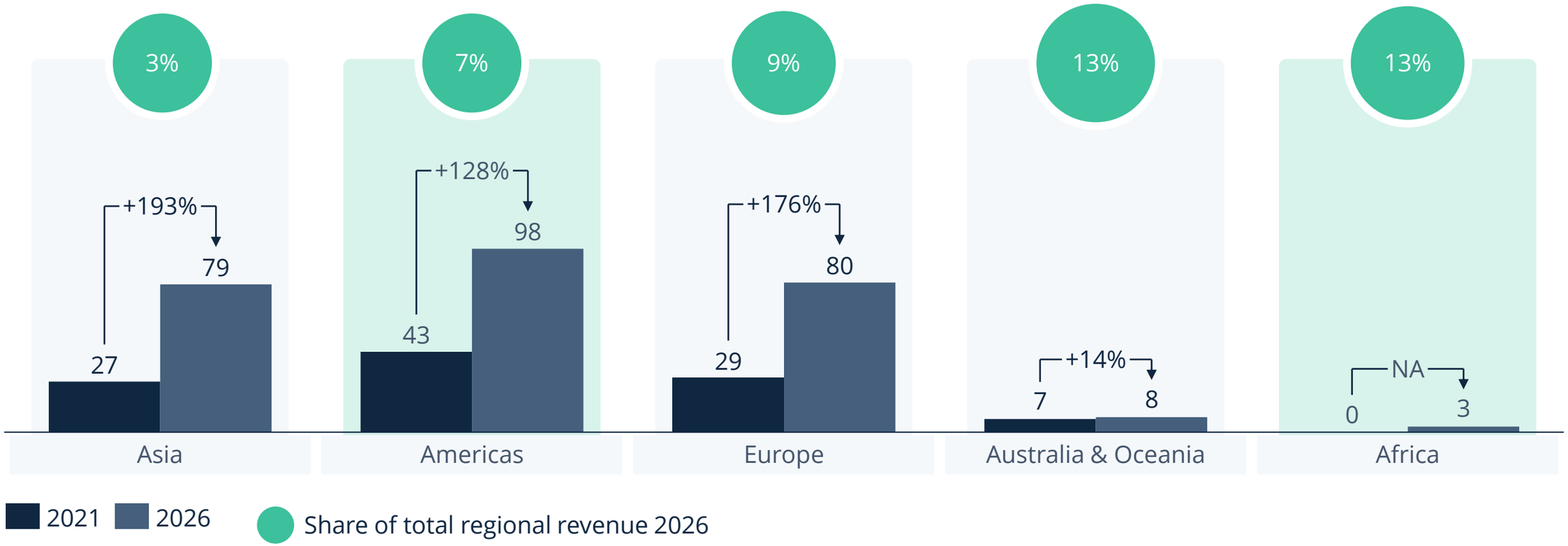

See the Market Profiles in action:

**Book A Demo**

ECDB

# Cross-Border E-Commerce Becomes a Larger Contributor to Global GMV Growth with the Americas Leading in Scale and Asia in Growth

**Global cross-border e-commerce revenue growth (imports between countries within region, US$ bn)**





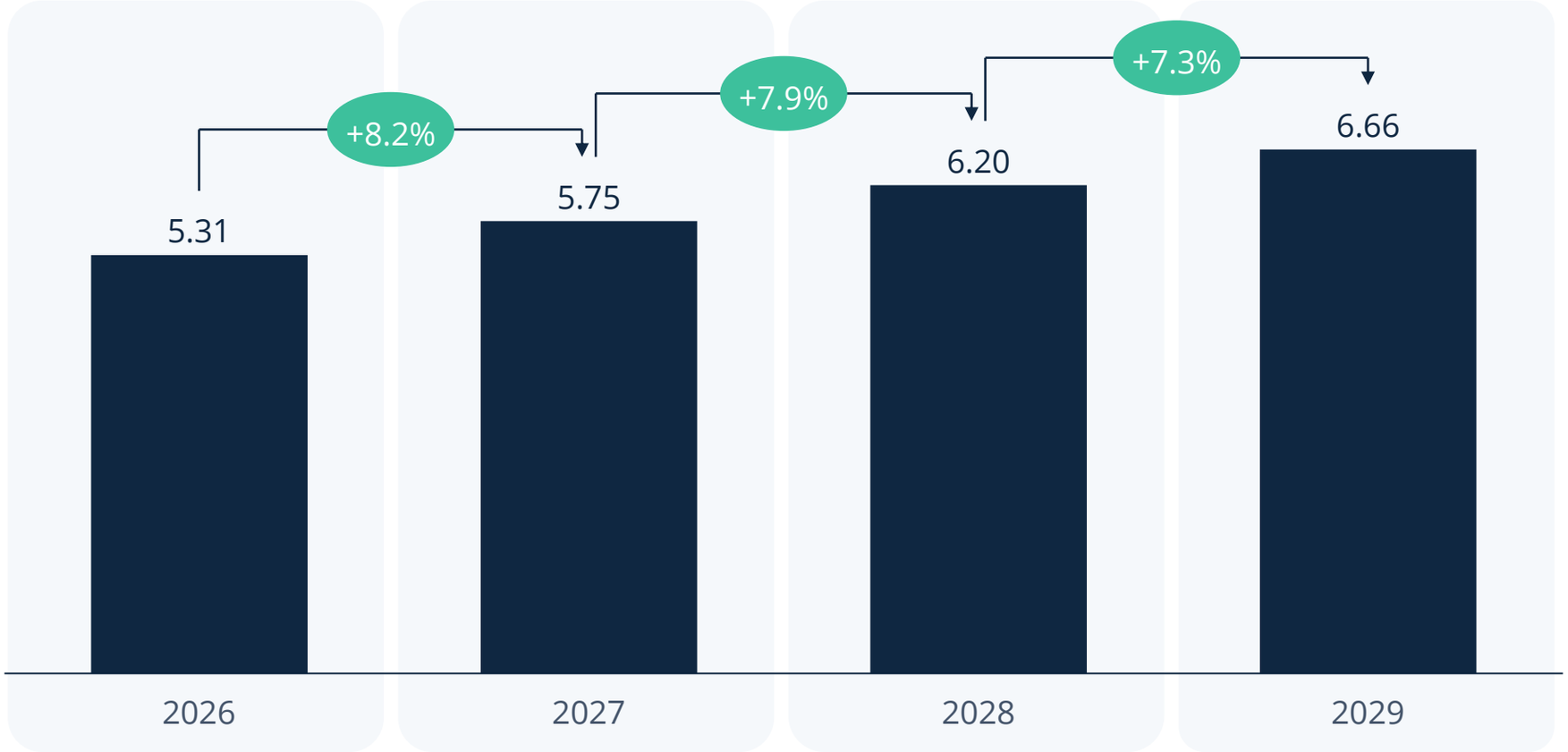

**Notes:** Definition cross border e-commerce: Revenue generated by non-native online stores and shipped to customers in the respective foreign market

**Sources:** ECDB

ECDB

# Cross-Border E-Commerce Benefits Global Revenue Growth, Which Remains Above 7% Through 2029

**Global e-commerce revenue forecast (US$ tn)**




**Sources:** ECDB

### Cross-Border Growth Drivers

Global e-commerce revenues are expected to grow steadily at rates above 7% per year through 2029, pushing total market volume beyond the **US$ 6 trillion threshold already in 2028**.

This growth is partly driven by cross-border e-commerce due to:

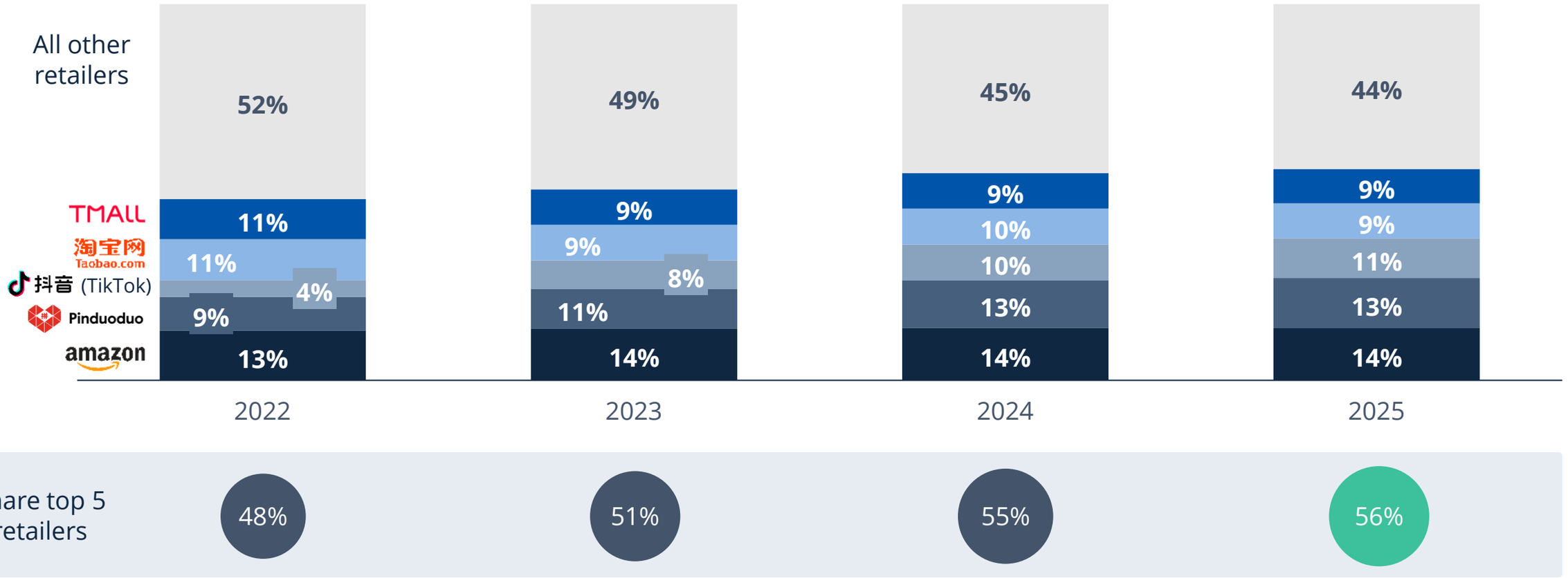
- **Larger global market opportunities:** Cross-border e-commerce enables retailers to access demand beyond saturated domestic markets.
- **Faster scaling for international brands:** Cross-border channels allow companies to expand internationally without heavy physical infrastructure investment.



ECDB

# Scale Advantage Intensifies: Top 5 Retailers Expanded Their GMV Share to 56 Percent in 2025

**Global GMV share top 5 retailers**




**Notes:** Top 5 retailer GMV figures are adjusted downward by 20% to align with modeled e-commerce market revenues, reflecting the definitional difference between gross merchandise value and net online sales (see page 6)

**Sources:** ECDB

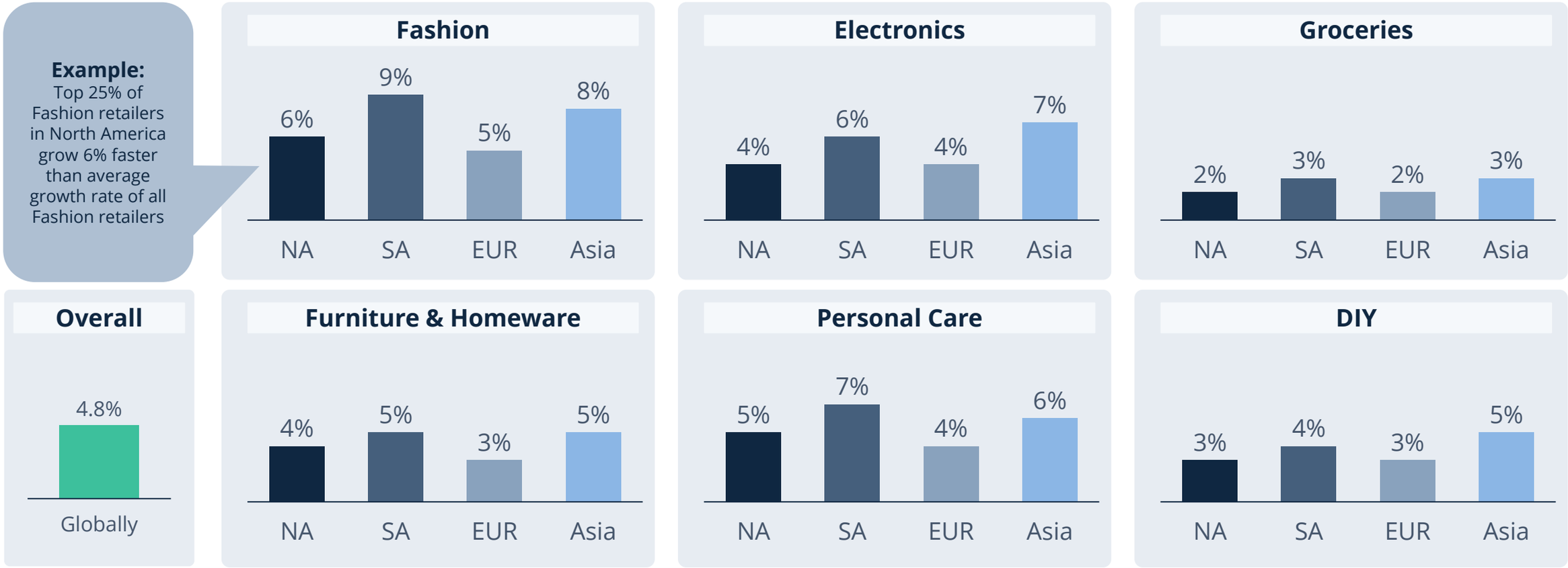


ECDB

# Top 25% of Retailers Grow Significantly Faster Than the Market, Accelerating Global Concentration

**Surplus growth rate of top 25% retailers[1] vs. market average by category and region (2025)**

**Example:** Top 25% of Fashion retailers in North America grow 6% faster than average growth rate of all Fashion retailers





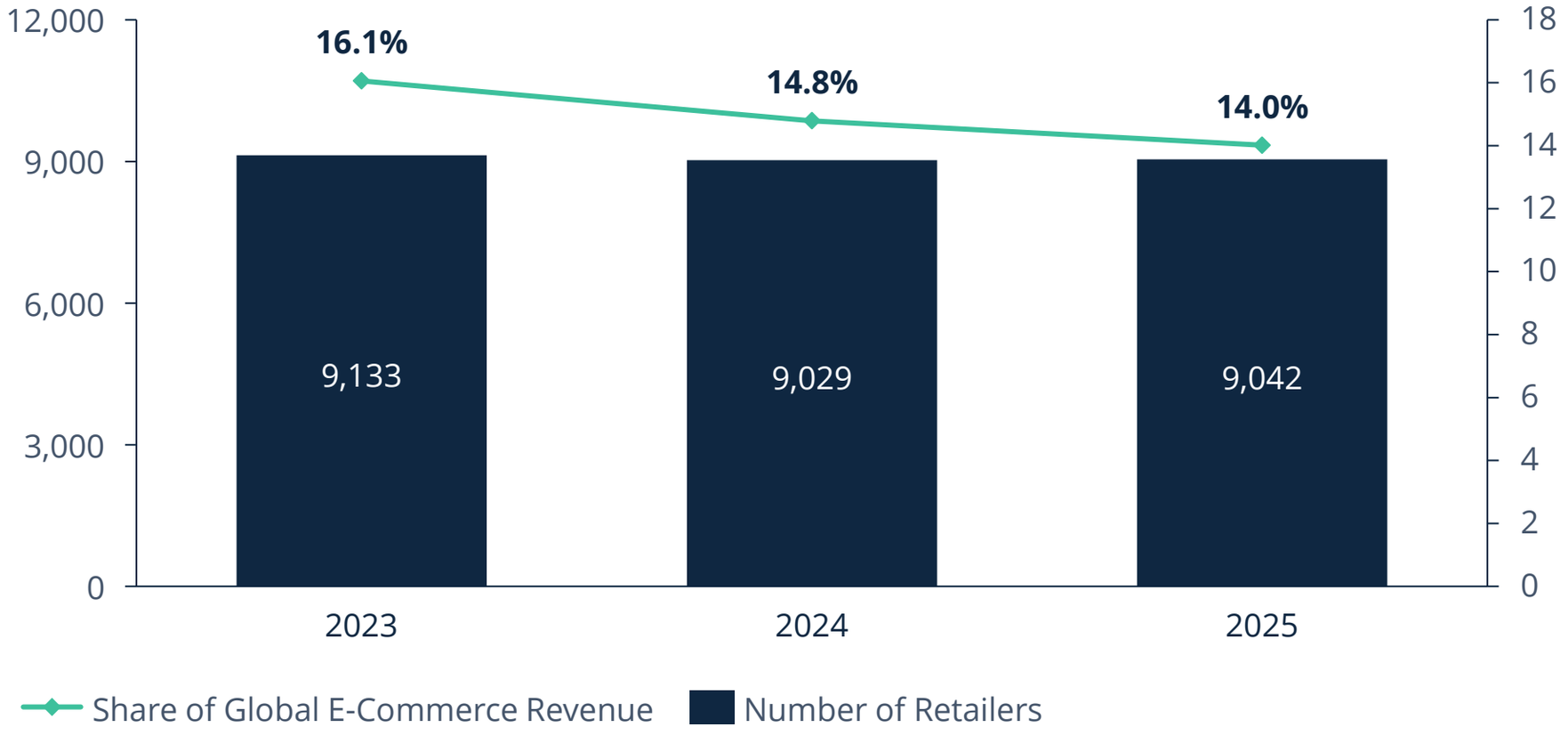

**Notes:** NA = North America, SA = South America, EUR = Europe (1) By GMV

**Sources:** ECDB

ECDB

# Concentration of Top Retailers Leads to a Decline in the Number of Mid-Sized E-Commerce Retailers

**Number of retailers between US$10mn and US$1bn GMV and respective market share worldwide**




**Decline of Mid-Sized Retailers**

Growing concentration of top retailers leads to a decline in mid-sized e-commerce retailers and their share of the market.

The global number of mid-sized retailers (US$10 mn to US$1 bn GMV) fell from 9,133 in 2023 to 9,042 in 2025.

Over the same period, their share of total global e-commerce revenues decreased from 16.1% to 14.0%. This shift has left a larger share of total revenues in the hands of leading platforms with GMV exceeding US$1bn.

Competitive dynamics increasingly favor large platforms, while mid-sized operators face growing challenges in sustaining growth and defending market share.



**Sources:** ECDB

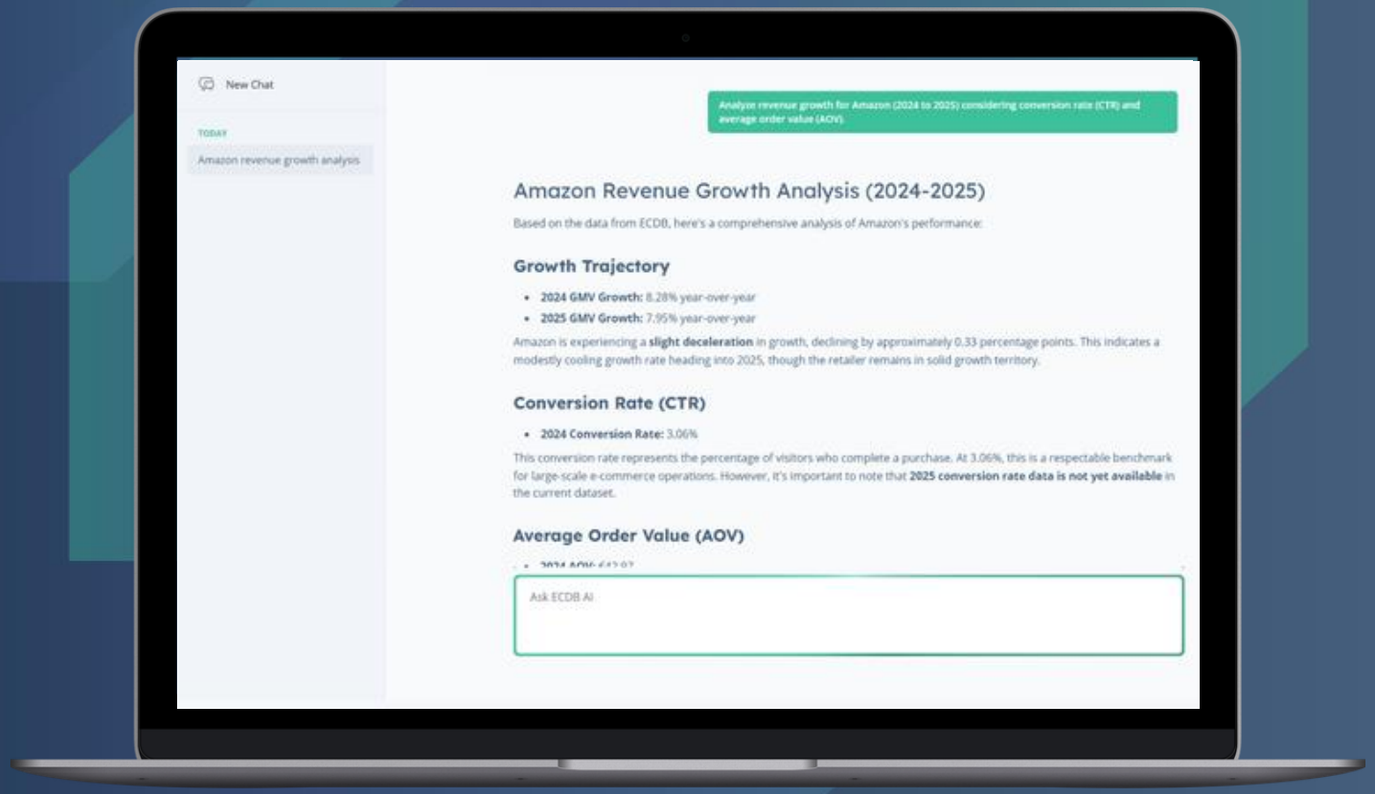
ECDB

# Get Answers Without Digging Through Data

- Get structured answers across markets, retailers, and categories
- Spend less time searching and more time making decisions
- Get reliable, data-backed answers you can trust

See ECDB AI in action:

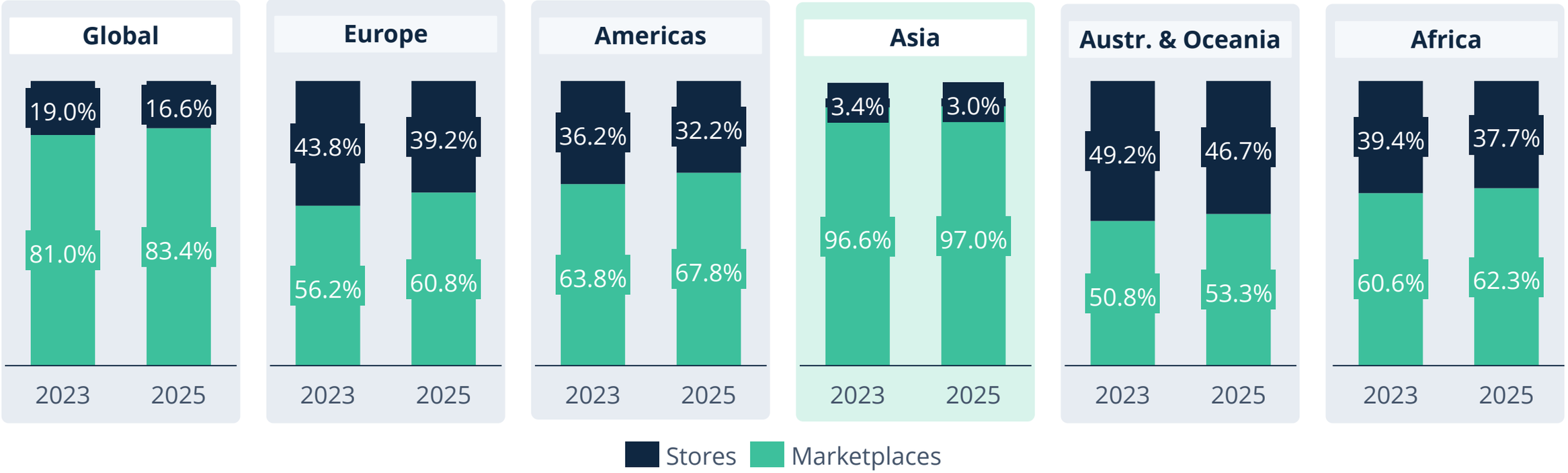
**Book A Demo**




ECDB

# Marketplace Dominance in E-Commerce Rises as Marketplace Shares Grow, Varying Strongly Across Regions with Asia Clearly Ahead

**GMV share stores vs. marketplaces overall by region**




Higher marketplace shares correlate with market concentration, while fragmented regions sustain stronger store-led e-commerce models

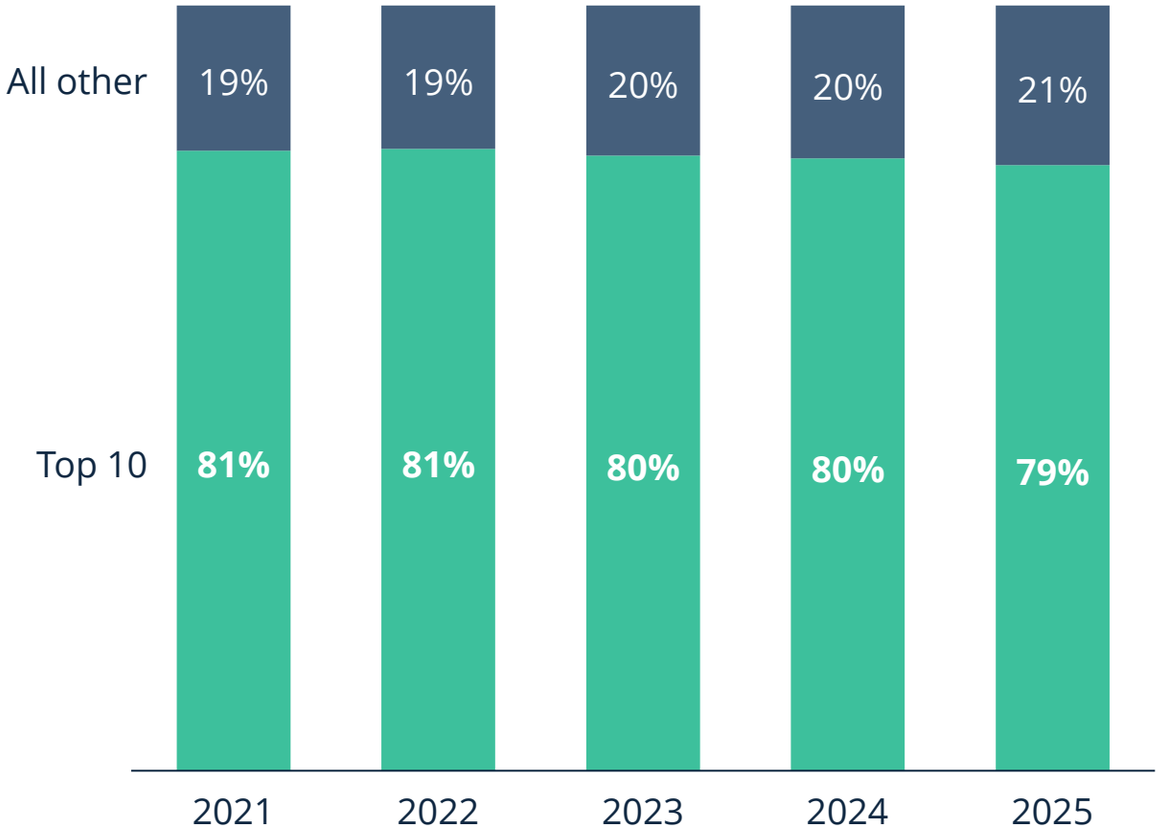


**Sources:** ECDB

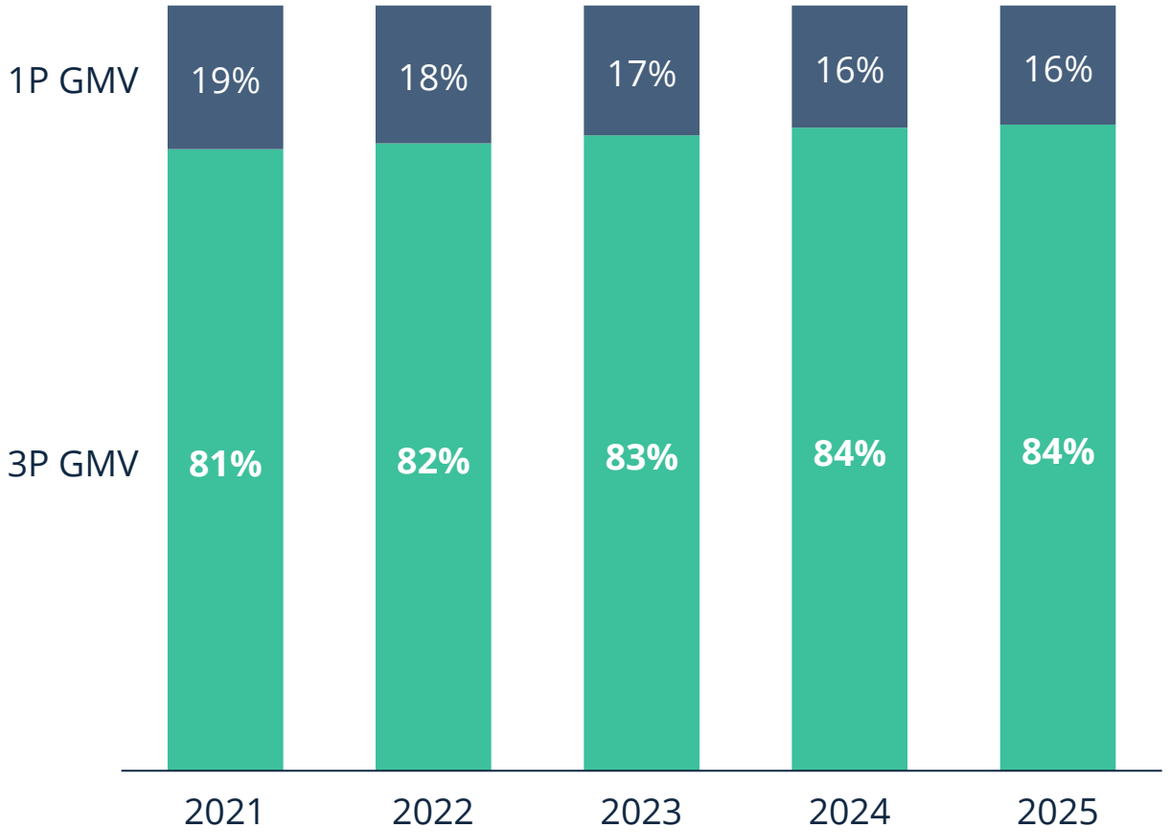
ECDB

# Marketplace GMV Is Highly Concentrated at 80 Percent While Third-Party Sellers Continue to Gain Share on Marketplaces

**GMV distribution by segment**




**GMV distribution by 1P vs. 3P**





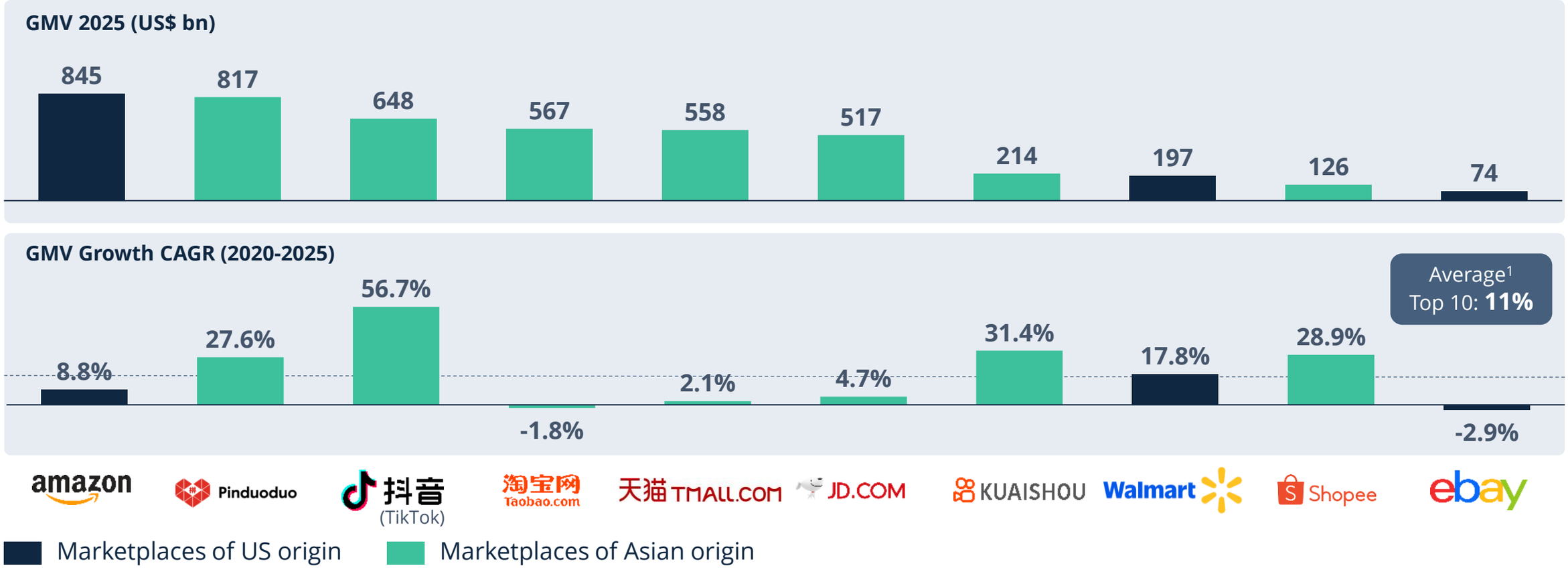

**Notes:** Top 10 marketplaces are: Amazon, Pinduoduo, Douyin/Tiktok, JD.com, Taobao.com, TMALL.com, Kuaishou, Walmart, Shopee, ebay

**Sources:** ECDB

ECDB

# Amazon Is the Largest Marketplace Platform, Followed by Six Asian Marketplaces Showing Mixed Growth Development

**GMV and growth of top 10 marketplaces worldwide**






**Sources:** ECDB

ECDB

# Marketplace Leader: Amazon's .com Store Accounts for 51% of Global GMV While Market Share Peaks at 58.5% in Japan

**Amazon stores by total GMV (2025, US$ mn)**

**Amazon share of total e-commerce revenue in select countries (2025)**

**Sources:** ECDB

ECDB

# Reveal Retailer Revenue Drivers

- See where a retailer's revenue is actually generated
- Understand what drives growth and where revenue leaks occur
- See what limits revenue scalability within a retailer's business

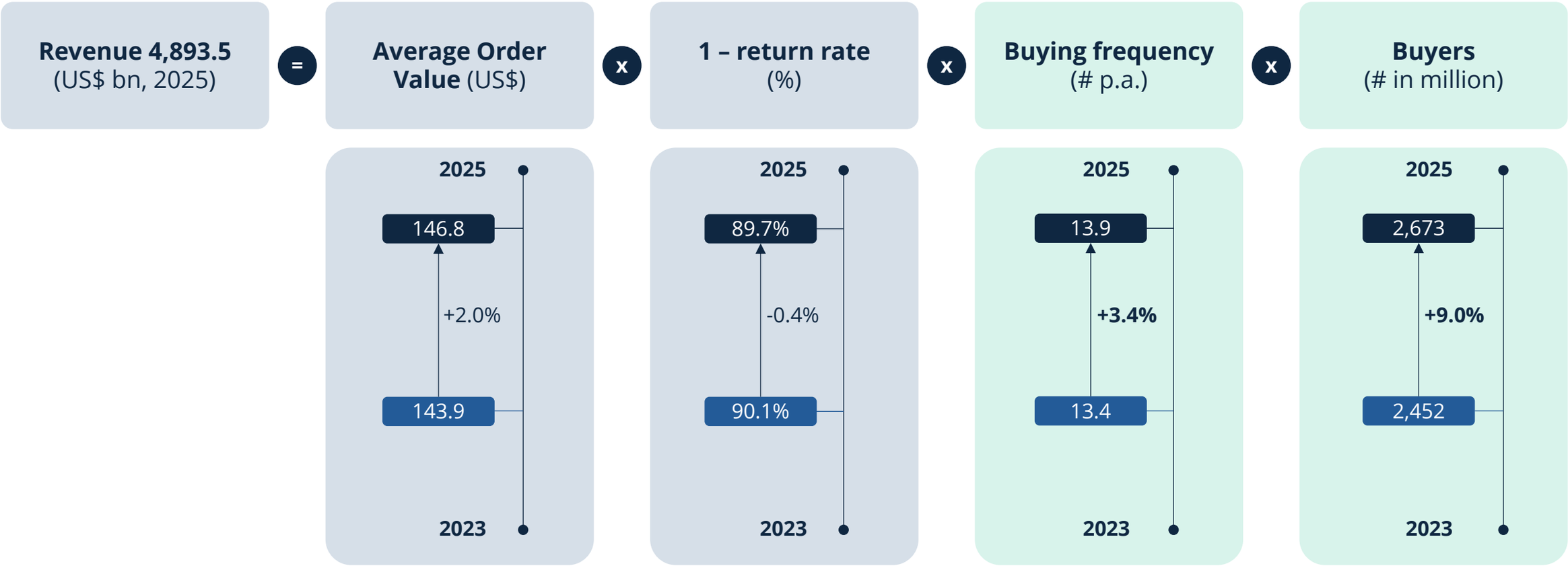
Explore our Retailer Profiles with the team:

**Book A Demo**

ECDB

# Buyer Acceleration: E-Commerce Growth Is Driven Mostly by the Growth of Buyers and Buying Frequency across the ECDB Revenue Equation

**ECDB Revenue Equation: global development of individual factors (2023 vs. 2025)**





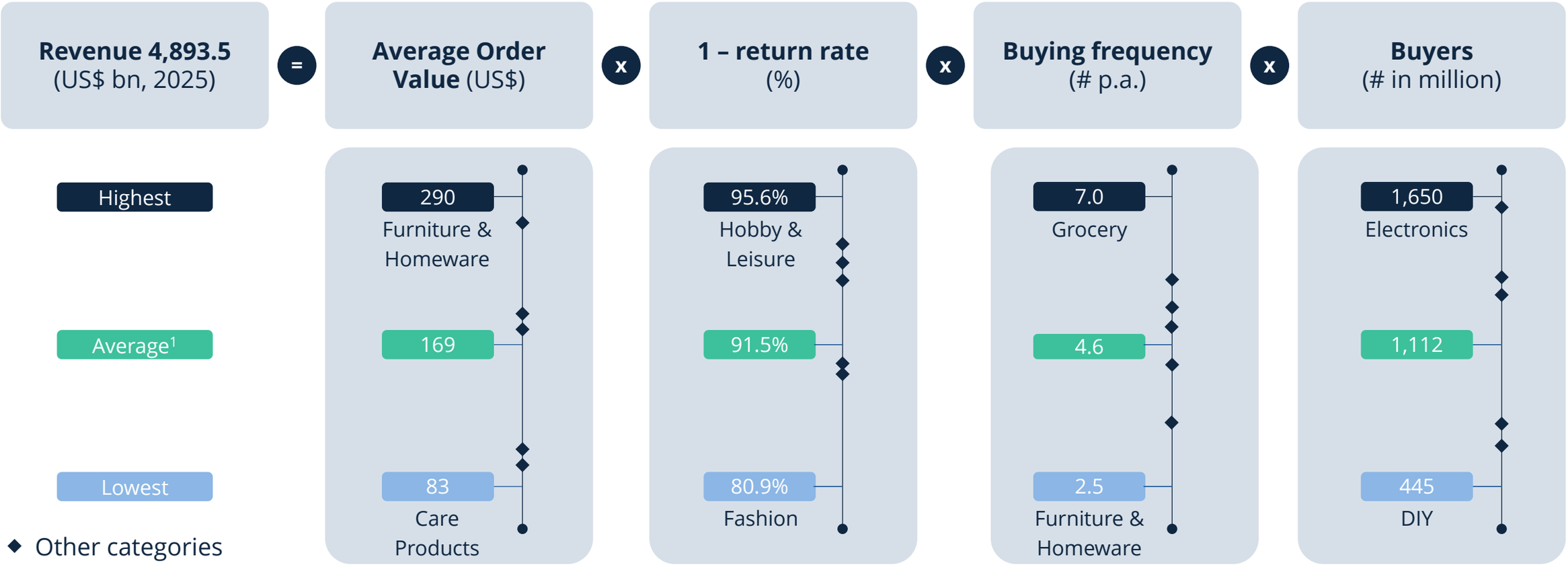

**Notes:** All values in US$ are gross (including VAT)

**Sources:** ECDB

ECDB

# Growth Drivers Across the Revenue Equation Differ Strongly by Category

**ECDB Revenue Equation: spread across factors (2025)**




**Notes:** All values in US$ are gross (including VAT) (1) Unweighted average per category

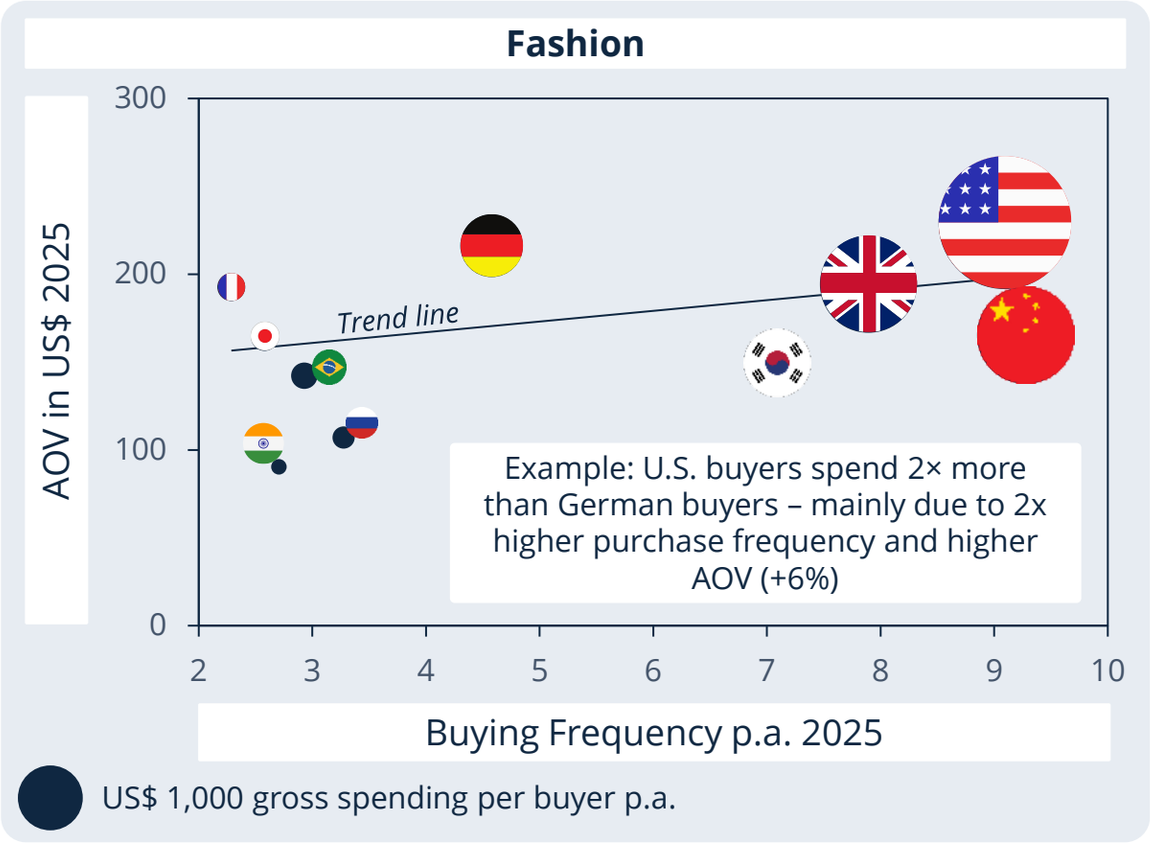
**Sources:** ECDB

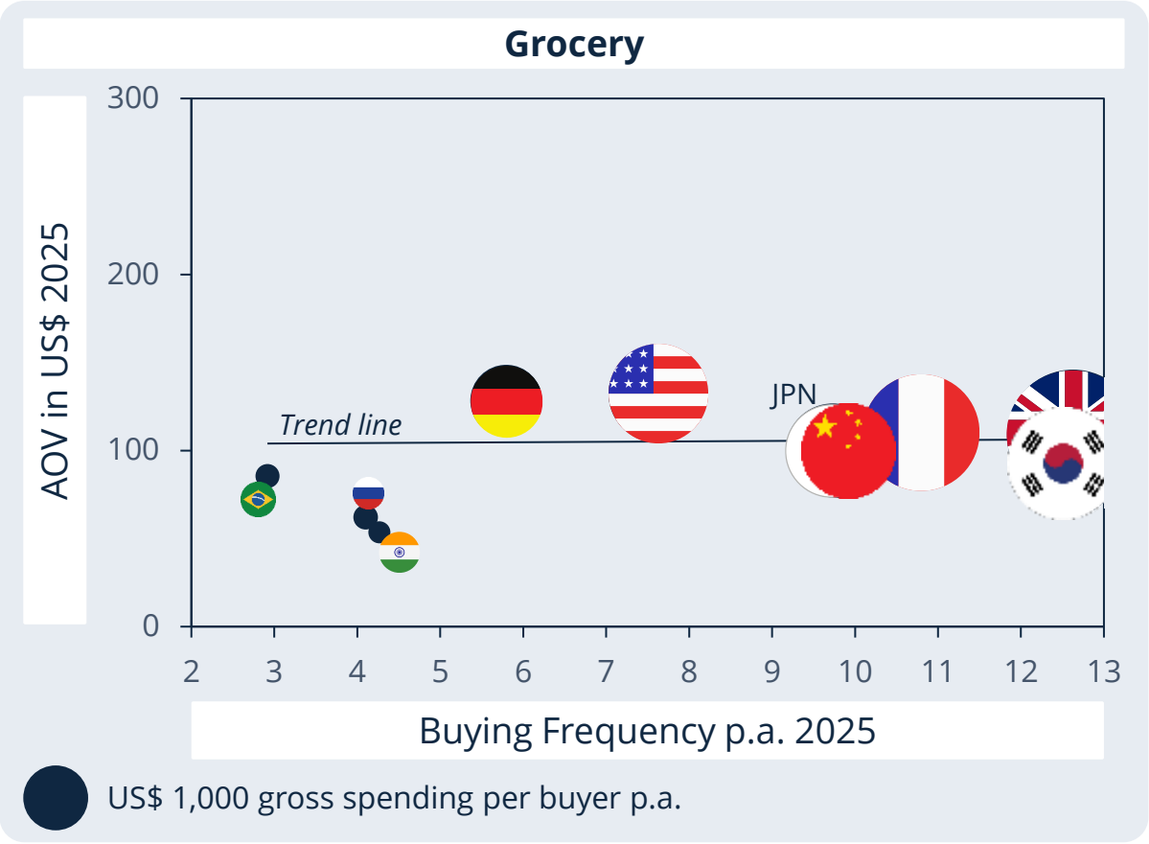


ECDB

# Buying Frequency and AOV Differ Strongly Between Countries and Categories – Driven Mainly by Category Needs

**ECDB Revenue Equation: buying frequency, AOV and gross spending per buyer per year for top 10 largest e-commerce countries (2025)**






**Notes:** All values in US$ are gross (including VAT)

**Sources:** ECDB

ECDB

# Make Competitive Differences Visible

- Identify emerging players and momentum early
- Compare strengths and weaknesses side by side
- See competitive shifts and understand what drives them

Explore Analyze & Compare live:

**Book A Demo**

ECDB

# Two Phases of AI-Powered Shopping: From Traffic Shift to Control Shift

**Present: traffic shift** → **Near future: control shift**

## 1 AI Shopping Traffic

**Traffic from generative AI** sources (e.g., ChatGPT, Google Gemini, DeepSeek, Perplexity)

Purchasing decisions are supported by AI, while **transactions remain user-controlled at the retailer** (web, app)

AI acts as a discovery and consideration layer, not as a merchant

Shift of traffic within the upper funnel

## 2 Agentic Commerce

Use of **AI agents to complete entire shopping journeys**

AI becomes the **primary decision-maker and transaction interface**

Traditional **retailer touchpoints** (web, app) **lose direct relevance**

Disintermediation of purchasing & transaction control

### From Traffic to Control Shift

A current shift in traffic is occurring from AI-driven sources, such as ChatGPT, Google Gemini, DeepSeek, and Perplexity. In this model, AI influences purchasing decisions and guides product discovery, while the final transactions remain under user control through retailer websites or apps.

Essentially, AI functions as a discovery and consideration layer rather than a merchant. In the future, this dynamic may evolve further, with AI agents handling entire shopping journeys, becoming both the primary decision maker and the transaction interface. As a result, traditional retailer touchpoints could lose direct relevance, reshaping the customer experience and commerce journey.



**Sources:** ECDB

# Four AI Shopping Use Cases – From Assisted Discovery to Delegated Purchasing

Increasing role and control by AI agent

### AI-Assisted Discovery Purchase

*Example: laptop bag for business travel*

**AI**: Searches, compares and shortlists products

**Human**: Decides and completes the purchase

We are currently here

### AI-Enabled One-Click Checkout

*Example: noise-cancelling headphones*

**AI**: Recommends product and executes checkout after confirmation

**Human**: Confirms the purchase

### Autonomous Replenishment Agent

*Example: pet food or household consumables*

**AI**: Selects retailer, price and timing autonomously

**Human**: Defines needs and spending rules

### Fully Delegated Commerce Agent

*Example: everyday household shopping*

**AI**: Manages shopping end-to-end across categories and retailers

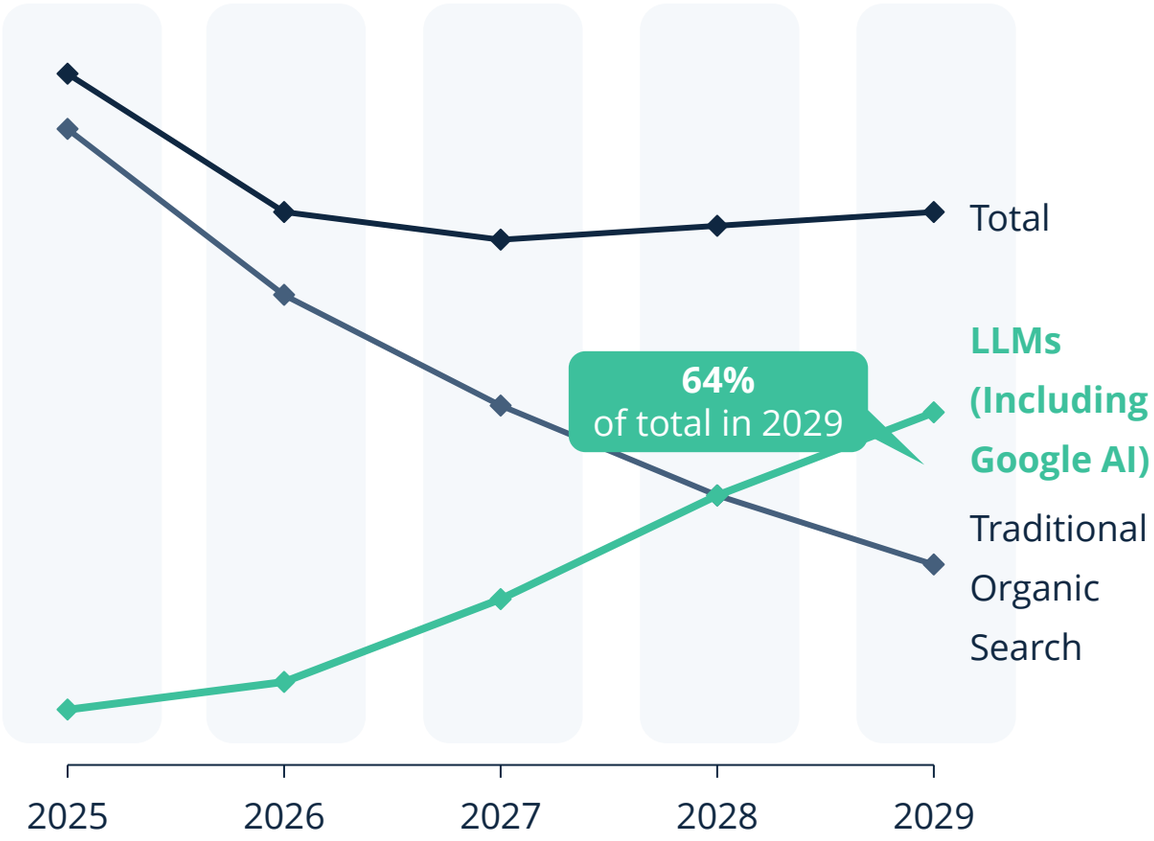
**Human**: Sets preferences and budgets only



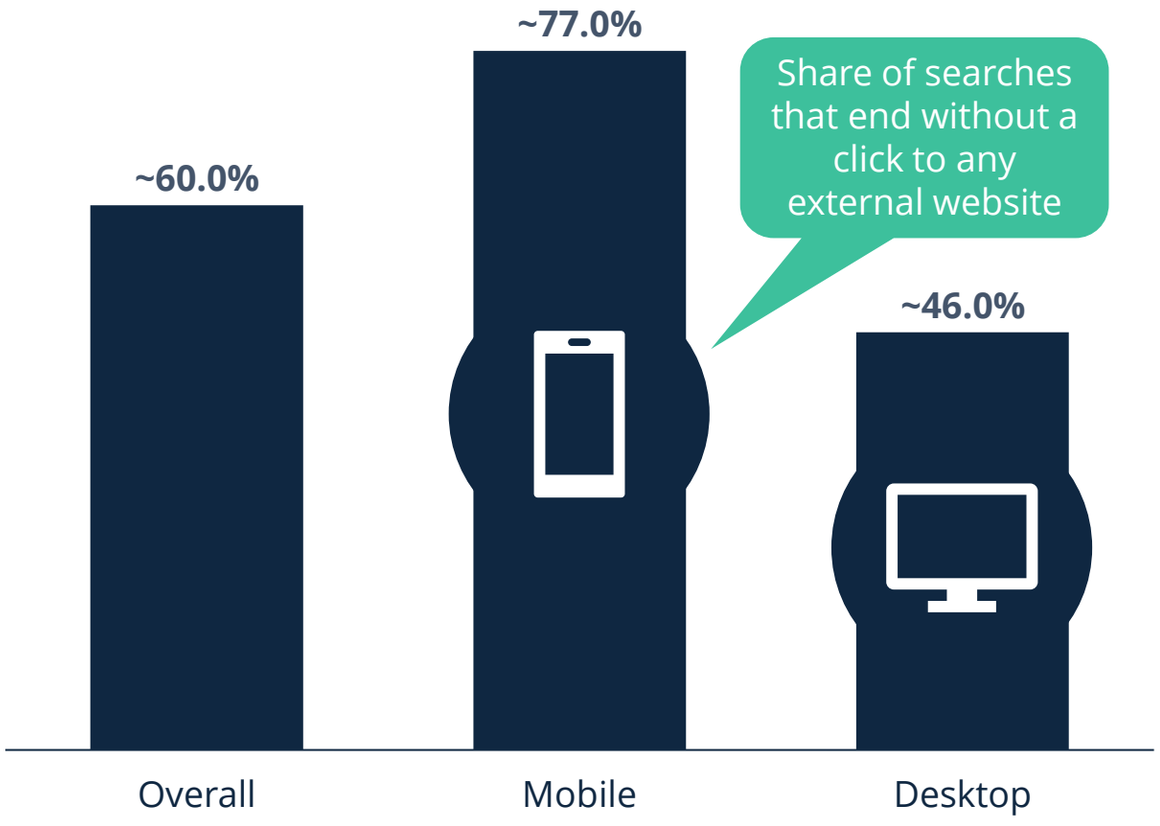
**Sources:** ECDB

# AI Traffic Will Overtake Traditional Search in 2028 while 60 Percent of Searches are Zero-Click Searches Already

**Projected annual visitors by source**




**Share of zero-click search results (2025)**



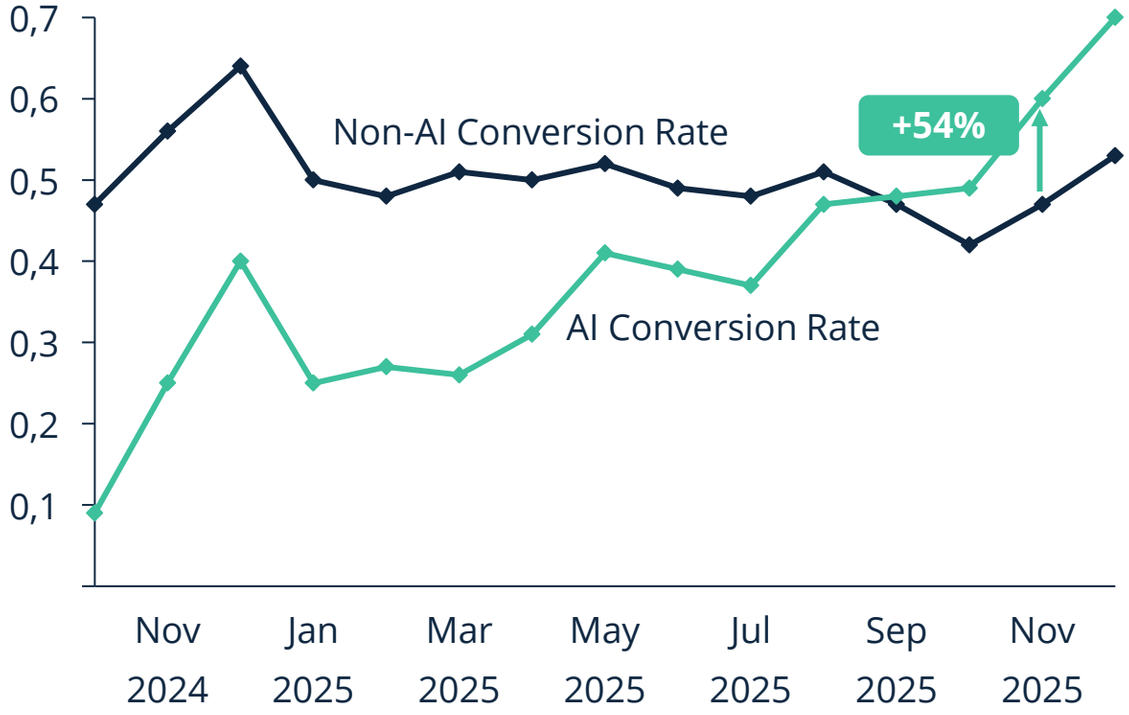



**Sources:** Semrush, SparkToro, ECDB

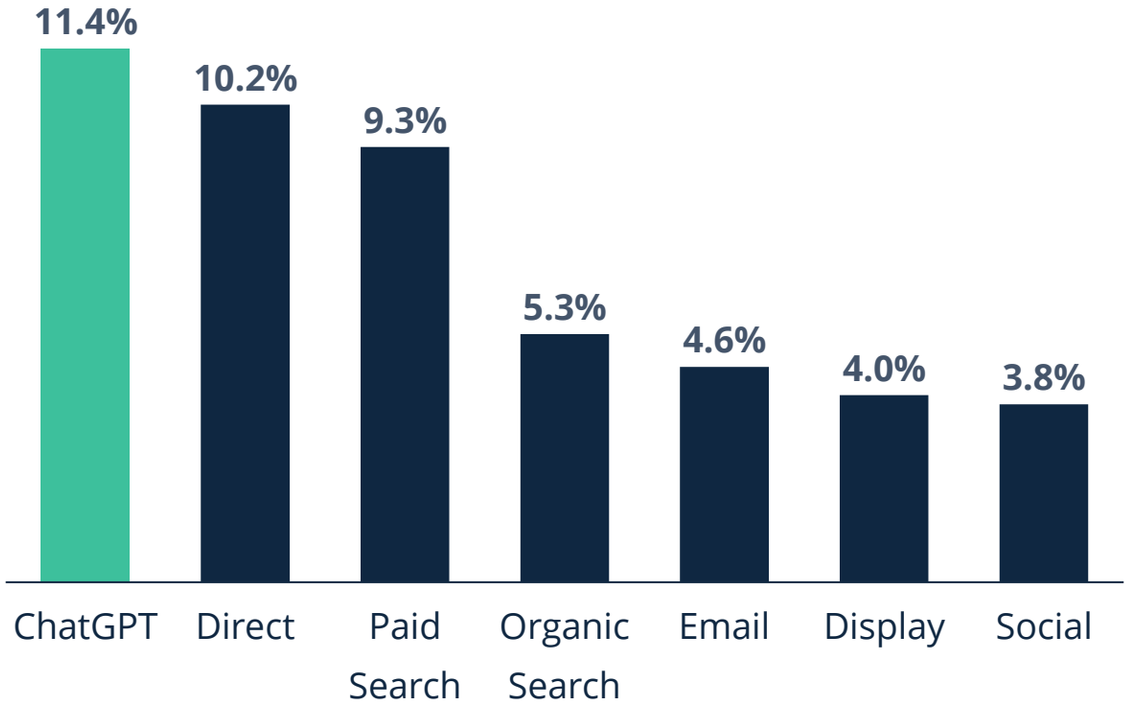
ECDB

# AI Shopping Traffic with a Higher Conversation Rate than Traditional Traffic Sources

**Monthly indexed conversion rate (retail)[1]**




**Conversion rate of retail visits by source of referral (2025)**




AI shopping traffic is already valuable traffic for retailers



**Notes:** (1) Estimated from Adobe Digital Insights

**Sources:** Adobe, Similarweb, ECDB

ECDB

# E-Commerce Market Intelligence. Based on Billions of Transactions.

The Foundation Behind Every Insight in This Report

Book A Demo

See Pricing

ECDB